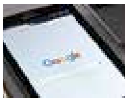
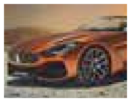


Google brings video preview
Google announced a major update to its mobile's "Search results now" feature - a six-secod video preview. **http://dgit.in/6secGoogle**



BMW's new Z4 prototype
Unveiled at the Monterey Car Week, BMW's new Z4 prototype is a sports car with a brand new chassis made in partnershipn with Toyota. **http://dgit.in/BMWZ41**

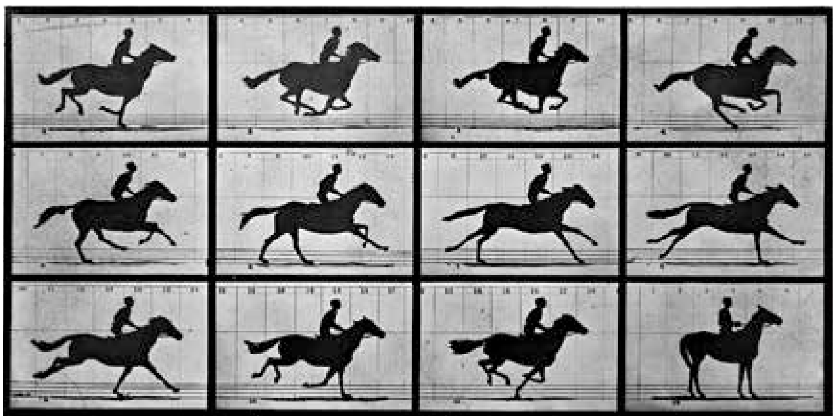
out "It's alive! It's aliiiivvveeee?", having created actual life inside a lab? But Dr. Romesberg assures that creating synthetic life isn't feasible for a long time to come and even then, it won't be anything as complex as an animal or human being. Our cell structure is just too complex to be easily modified. But what we should be looking at is the possibility of lab grown proteins. This definitely has the potential to revolutionise that field by creating a whole different variety of protein – perhaps we could even make lab grown bacon that tastes better than real bacon? Only time (and science!) will tell.

GIFS AND PHOTOS IN DNA

Scientists over at Harvard University have successfully encoded and decoded a GIF as well as a photo from the DNA of bacteria: (http://dgit.in/DNAMeme). That's it, pack it up boys. The future is finally here.

Sounds right out of science fiction doesn't it? The team over at Harvard managed this astounding feat from a rather innocuous bacterial response. The immune system of any organism, once it has finished fighting the threat of an incoming virus, adds a part of the virus to it's own genetic code to better 'remember' how to fight it, should it encounter it again. Scientists created "fake" viruses that contain the pixels of the image encoded into its genetic makeup. In this particular trial, the team at Harvard used an image of the human hand as well as one of the most historic GIFs in the world – Sallie Gardner at a Gallop. They made these image coded viruses infect strains of E.Coli and let the genetic code copy them. (They broke the GIF down into 5 frames and fed a frame a day to the bacteria culture) Once this was done, they were able to reconstruct both the image and the GIF with over 90% accuracy from the bacteria's genome!

This is truly amazing news. This could mean that bacteria could become our new storage medium in cases like measuring the impact of global warming in different places or having a living cell record what exactly is happening to it in real time – opening up all new avenues of study in different fields.



The historic GIF that got even more historic

CLEARING TYPOS IN EMBRYOS

CRISPR can be theoretically used to do a lot of amazing things, such as treating cancer, sickle cell anemia and even high cholesterol! Provided we figure out how to isolate the specific parts of the genetic code in our DNAs that end up causing these diseases. But recently, scientists have hit a huge milestone in developing CRISPR – being able to edit the 'typo' in the genetic code of a human embryo, thereby removing the chance of an inherited disease. One of Life Science's most prestigious universities, Salk University in San Diego, California, in conjunction with the Oregon Health & Science University and Korea's Institute for Basic Science, managed to successfully cut out the genetic code that would've lead to hypertrophic cardiomyopathy in an IVF embryo (colloquially known as a test tube baby) with no side effects (http://dgit.in/EmbrEdit). This has huge implications for our future, where babies can be monitored for any genetic diseases and 'cured' of them, even before birth. Perhaps, we can soon expect the scientists to figure out how to remove specific disease markers in the body, which make a person more predisposed to particular diseases. Either ways, this achievement needs to be lauded and appreciated just because of the millions of children in the future who needn't go through a rough childhood due to an inherited disease.

CRISPR HAS A DARK SIDE

It's not all roses. Researchers working on CRISPR trials on mice have cautioned the world that editing a particular stretch of a genetic code can have far-reaching and unthought-of side effects and mutations that may occur. One of these researchers, Stephen Tsang of Columbia University's Medical Center says that, "We feel it's critical that the scientific community consider the potential hazards of all off-target mutations caused by CRISPR, including single nucleotide mutations and mutations in non-coding regions of the genome,". The researchers used CRISPR to successfully correct genetic blindness in mice but once they sequenced the whole genome after the trial, they found more than 1500 mutations and over 100 large gene sequence deletions and insertions that the computer's predictive algorithm didn't account for. While it is unclear right now what these mutations mean for the mice, chances are high that there could be some highly undesirable and downright dangerous side effects (http://dgit.in/X-Mice).

Does this mean that the CRISPR hype is dead? Thankfully, not. The researchers are still very optimistic about CRISPR. They just urge extreme caution when using the tool, especially since clinical trials on humans have started. The predictive algorithms still have a lot of optimisation and learning to do. "Researchers who aren't using